Dunbar High, Oh Dunbar High, You Taught Your Children Well

You were our only house of learning during a
terrible time in history when segregation reined.
You sheltered and protected our little minds
from a social ill that racism had soiled and stained.

Your classrooms were cold during the wintertime,
and the radiators didn't always work so well.
Yet, each day your housekeepers (our teachers)
taught, taught, and taught, until the next sounding bell.

Our books were torn, ragged, and littered
with derogatory and profane writings galore.
They were hand-me-downs from the white school
across town, need I dare bother and say more.

But, oh how we buckled down, and
searched those old ragged pages for facts.
We may have been poor, Black, and miserable,
but we left a proud legacy of educational tracks.

Your construction was completed in nineteen and twenty-six,
and was the only Black high school in the county of Lee.
Up until the year of sixty-two (last graduating class in your house)
we steadily entered your doors and enjoyed the shade of your Banyan Tree.

Since leaving the knowledge filled wraps of
your embrace, we have scattered near and far.
We have collected bachelors, masters, and doctorate
degrees to begin giving a sketch of who we were, and who we really are.

Some of your children are now hospitals fine doctors,
courts fine lawyers, and robed judges with gavels in hand.
They are preachers, teachers, cops, and city officers, oh by golly,
Sweet Jesus; they are singing your praises all over this land.

We have come home to roost for a moment, and the sight of you
roused our memories, and this short story was in your honor, and one
we just had to tell.
We who are children of your house of learning proudly
say to you: **"Dunbar High, Oh Dunbar High, You Taught Your Children Well."**